

PhotoTagger — User Guide

Find every photo of a player at an Ultimate Frisbee tournament — by jersey number, face, or name. PhotoTagger ingests a folder of game photos, detects faces and jersey numbers automatically, groups them by player, and matches them against your team rosters.

This guide walks you through the app from an empty database to a fully tagged photo gallery. Each step takes a minute or two; the whole workflow fits the four tabs across the top of the app.

Audience: photographers, team managers, and tournament organizers using the PhotoTagger web app. No coding required.

Before you start

PhotoTagger runs online — there's nothing to install. Just open the app in your web browser:

<https://phototagger-production.up.railway.app/upload>

That's it. The link above drops you straight onto the **Upload** tab. Any modern browser (Chrome, Safari, Firefox, or Edge) works.

 **Bookmark it.** You'll come back to this URL every time you tag a new game. Your rosters and tagged photos are saved between visits.

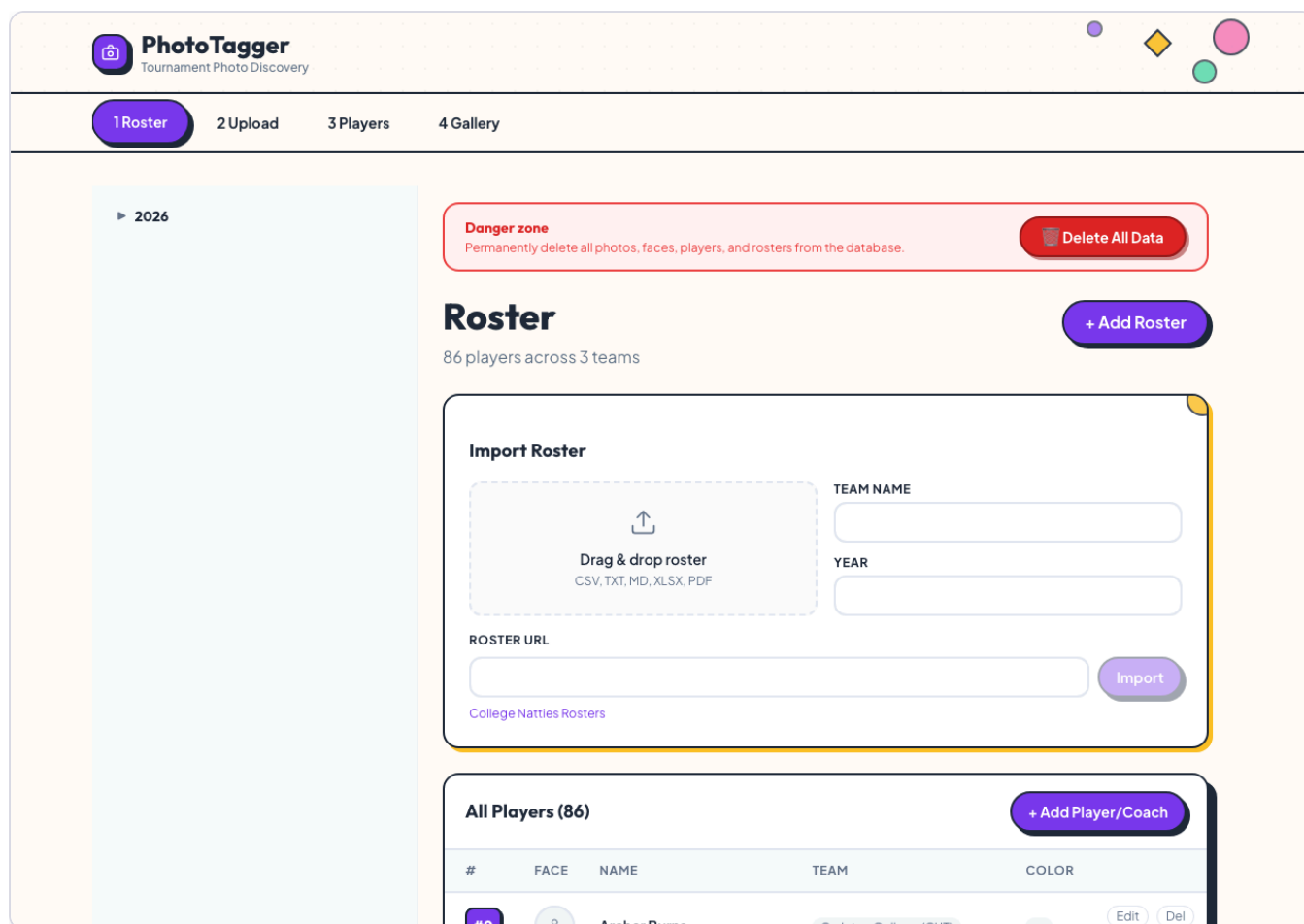
The app is organized as a numbered, left-to-right workflow:

1 Roster → 2 Upload → 3 Players → 4 Gallery

Work through the tabs in order the first time. After that, you can jump to any tab to search, re-tag, or add more photos.

Step 1 — Load your rosters

The **Roster** tab is where you tell PhotoTagger which players belong to which team. Roster data powers name lookups: once a jersey number is read off a photo, PhotoTagger matches it to the player wearing that number on that team.



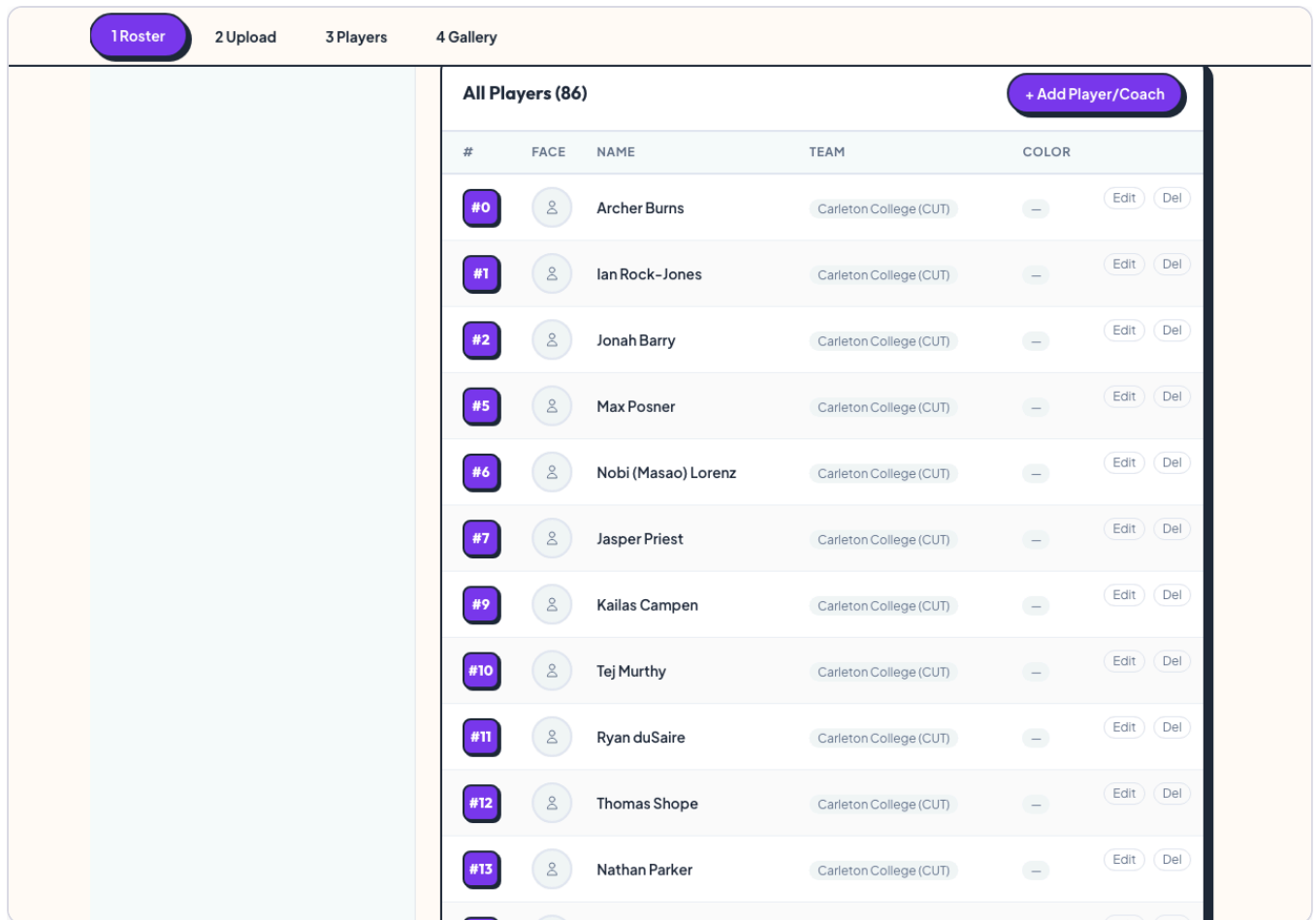
You have three ways to add a roster:

Method	How	Best for
Drag & drop file	Drop a CSV, TXT, MD, XLSX, or PDF onto the upload box	A roster file you already have
Roster URL	Paste a team's online roster page URL and click Import	College/club rosters published online
Manual entry	Click + Add Roster or + Add Player/Coach	Small teams or quick fixes

When importing, fill in **Team Name** and **Year** so players are scoped to the correct team and season.

Reviewing and editing players

Scroll down to **All Players** to see everyone you've imported, grouped by team. Each row shows the jersey number, an optional face thumbnail, the player name, the team, and the uniform color.

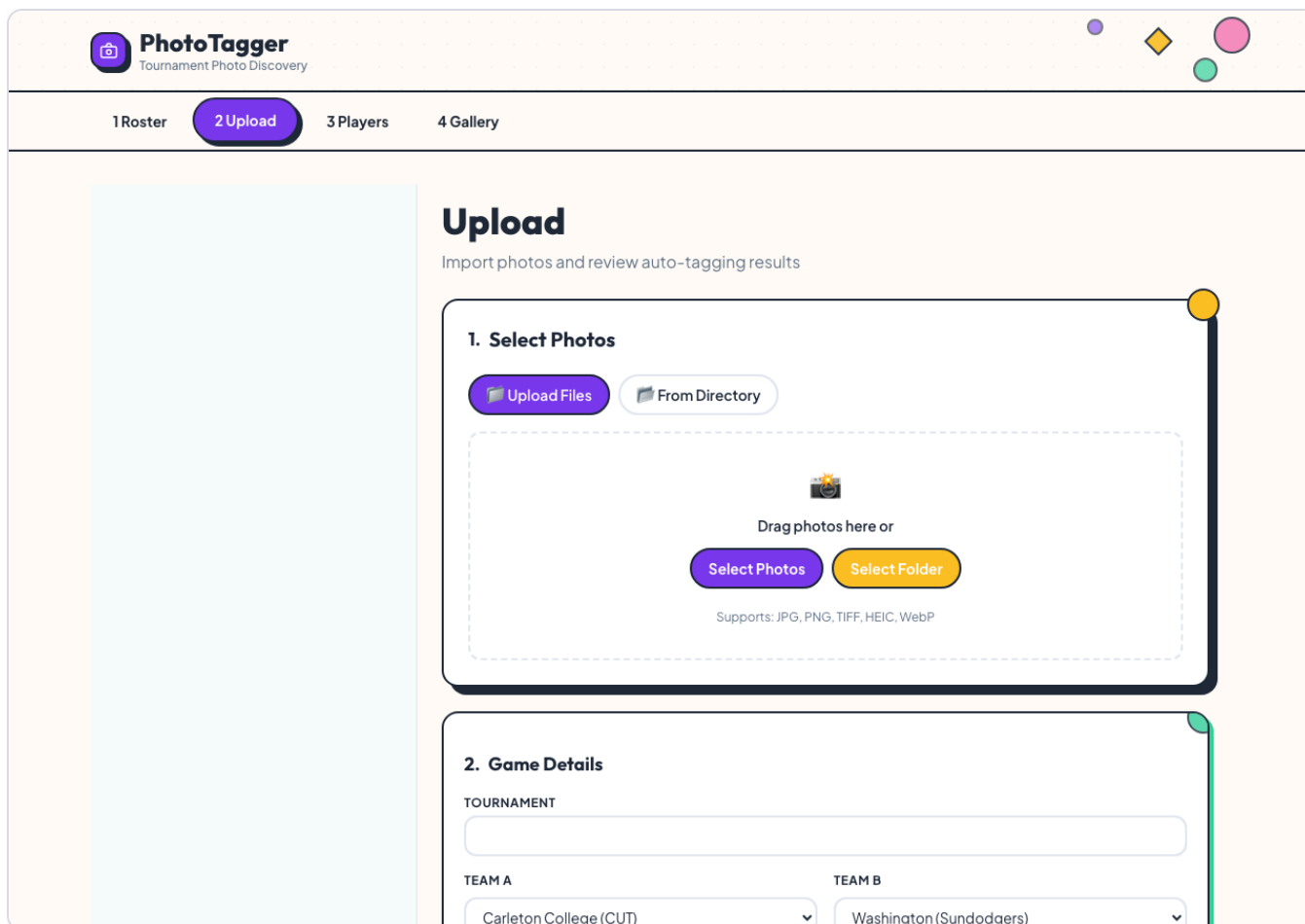


- Use **Edit** on any row to fix a number, name, or color.
- Use **Del** to remove a player.
- The **uniform color** matters: PhotoTagger uses it to disambiguate players when two teams wear different colors in the same game (see Step 2).

⚠ Danger zone. The red **Delete All Data** button at the top wipes every photo, face, player, and roster from the database. There is no undo. Only use it when starting completely fresh.

Step 2 — Upload photos and set the game

The **Upload** tab imports your photos and records the game context that makes auto-tagging accurate.



2a. Select photos

Choose one of two import modes:

- **Upload Files** — drag photos onto the box, or click **Select Photos** to pick individual files.
- **From Directory** — click **Select Folder** to import an entire folder at once (the fastest option for a full game shoot).

Supported formats: **JPG, PNG, TIFF, HEIC, WebP**.

2b. Enter game details

Scroll down to **Game Details**. This is the single most important step for accurate tagging.

1 Roster
2 Upload
3 Players
4 Gallery

2. Game Details

TOURNAMENT

TEAM A

Carleton College (CUT)

Carleton College (CUT) · 2026

TEAM B

Washington (Sundodgers)

Washington (Sundodgers) · 2026

JERSEY COLOR

black

JERSEY COLOR

white

3.

Save game & upload photos

Run OCR to see tagging results

Import Batches

Organize and tag groups of photos by import folder

Folder	Team	Year	Photos	Created
uploads /Users/brettevanssf/Code/Saasless/PhotoTagger/uploads	—	—	200	6/4/2026

Field	What to enter
Tournament	Free-text name of the event (optional)
Team A / Team B	Pick the two teams that played, from your imported rosters
Jersey Color (per team)	The shirt color each team wore in <i>this</i> game (e.g. black and white)

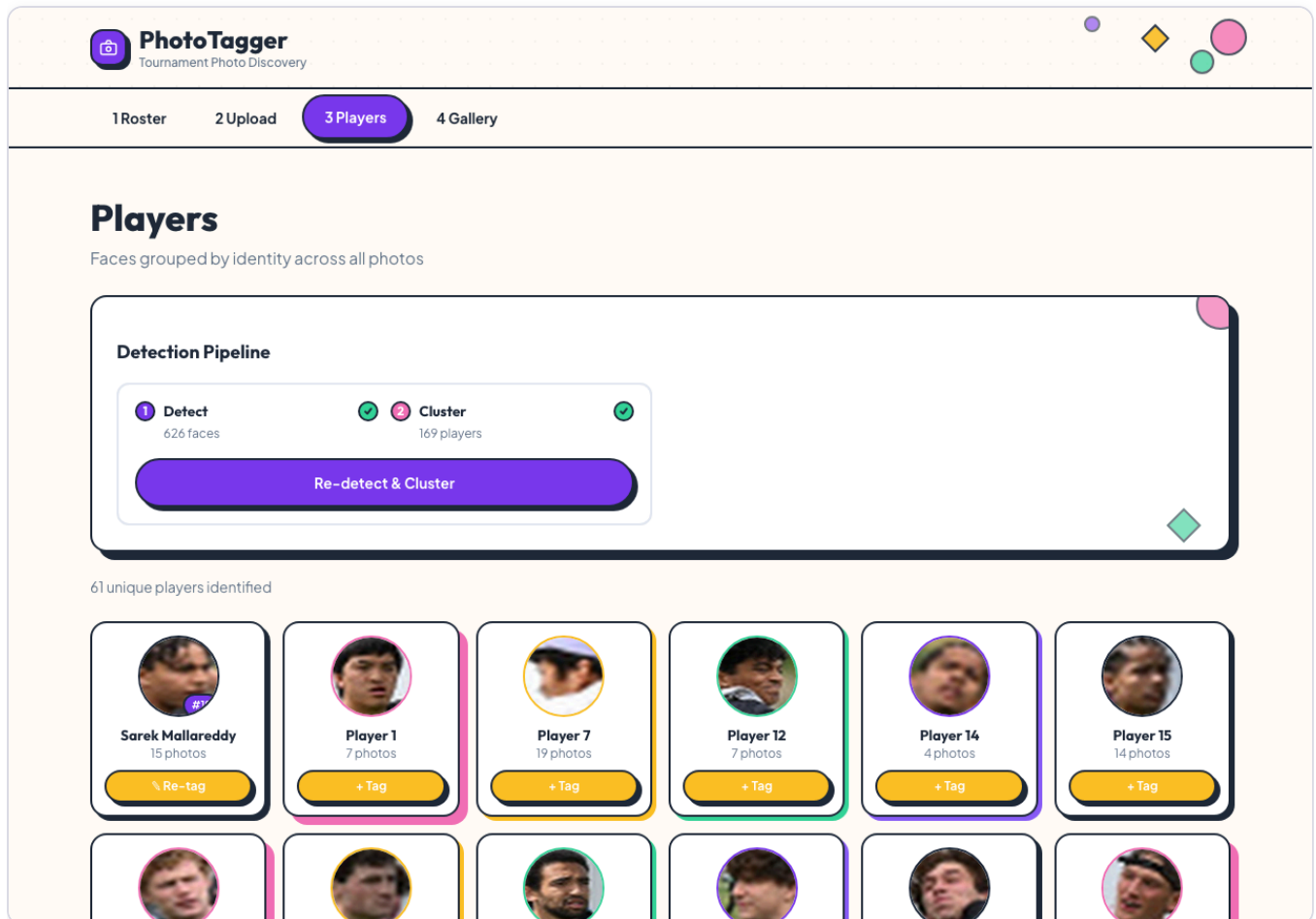
The jersey colors let PhotoTagger tell the two teams apart. When it reads "19" off a **black** jersey, it knows to look up #19 on the **black-wearing** team's roster — not the other team's.

2c. Save and run detection

1. Click **Save game & upload photos**. PhotoTagger ingests the images and records which game they belong to.
2. The **Run OCR to see tagging results** panel will process the photos — detecting jersey numbers and matching them to your rosters.
3. The **Import Batches** table at the bottom lists each imported folder with its team, year, and photo count, so you can track what's been processed.

Step 3 — Review players (faces grouped by identity)

The **Players** tab is where PhotoTagger shows its work. It runs face detection across every photo, then **clusters** the faces — grouping all the shots of the same person together, even before you've named them.



The Detection Pipeline

At the top, the **Detection Pipeline** card shows the two automated stages:

- **Detect** — how many faces were found (e.g. *626 faces*).
- **Cluster** — how many distinct people those faces resolve to (e.g. *169 players*).

A green check on each stage means it completed. Click **Re-detect & Cluster** any time you add new photos to refresh the grouping.

Player cards

Below the pipeline, each card is one clustered identity:

- Cards with a **jersey number badge and a real name** (e.g. *#19 Sarek Mallareddy*) were auto-matched — PhotoTagger read the number, looked it up on the correct team's roster, and tagged the player. These show a **Re-tag** button.

- Cards labeled **Player 1**, **Player 7**, etc. are unidentified clusters. The number of photos is shown, and a **+ Tag** button lets you assign a name.

Click any card to open that player's detail page.

Player detail page

The detail page shows every photo containing that player, with their face highlighted.

The screenshot shows the PhotoTagger interface. At the top, there's a navigation bar with tabs: 1 Roster, 2 Upload, 3 Players (selected), and 4 Gallery. Below this, a header for 'All Players' is visible. The main section is for 'Sarek Mallareddy #19', showing a profile picture, a 'Face on' button, and '15 photos · 15 appearances'. Below the header is a 'Re-tag this player' section with a search box labeled 'Search roster by name or number...'. The main content area displays a grid of 10 photo cards, each showing a player in action with a face highlight and a percentage (e.g., 79%, 82%, 76%, 80%, 83%, 84%, 79%, 77%, 83%, 85%). Each card has a 'Match others' button and a title 'Ultimate___CUT2025-26___N...'. The interface is clean and modern, with a light blue and white color scheme.

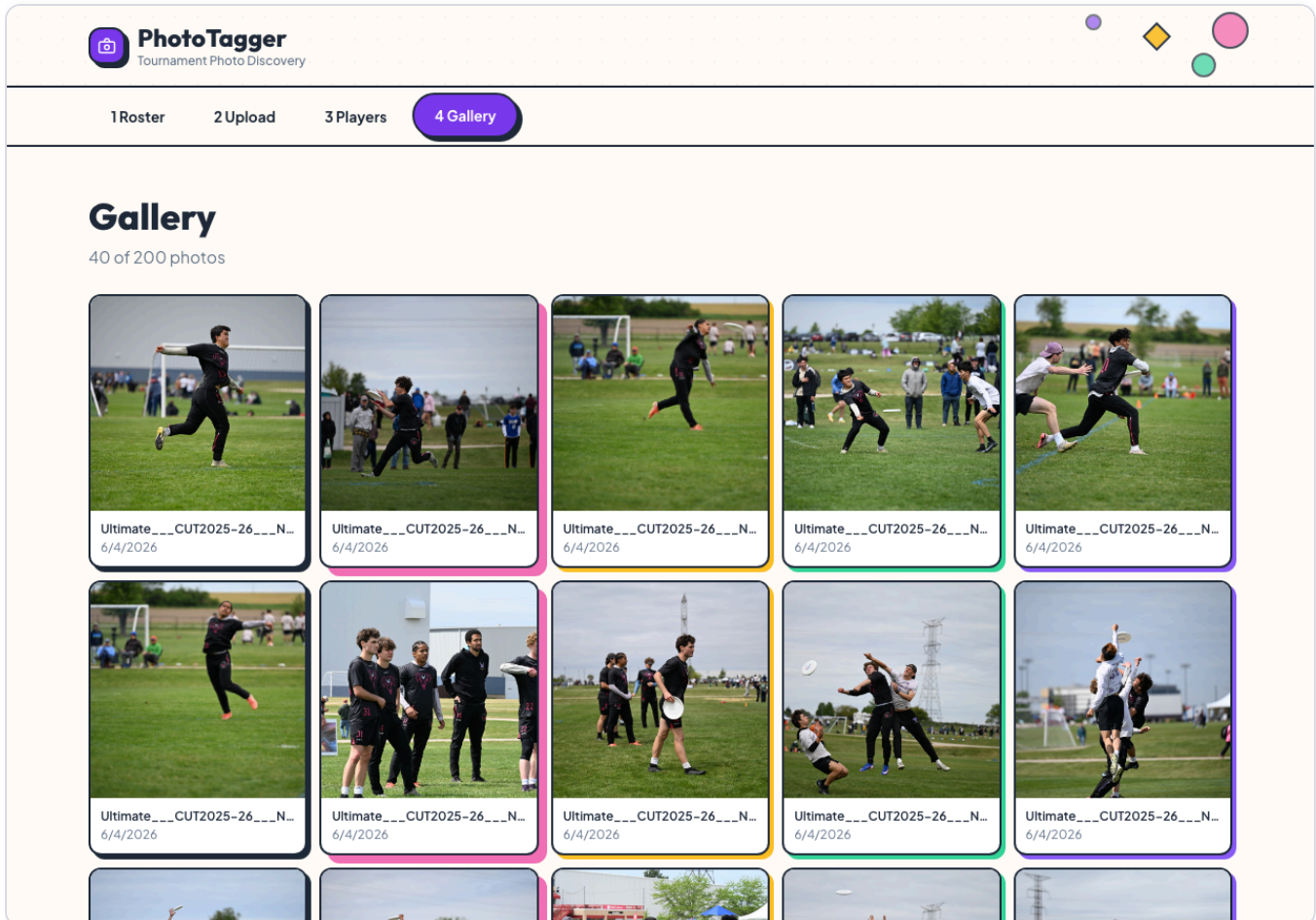
From here you can:

- **Tag by jersey** — type a number in the search box to assign this cluster to a roster player in one click.
- **Deselect photos** — if a photo was grouped in by mistake, remove it from the cluster so it doesn't pollute the player's results.
- Review the **appearances** count and jump back to **All Players**.

Tip: Tag the clusters with the most photos first. Naming a 19-photo cluster identifies that player across all 19 shots at once.

Step 4 — Browse and search the gallery

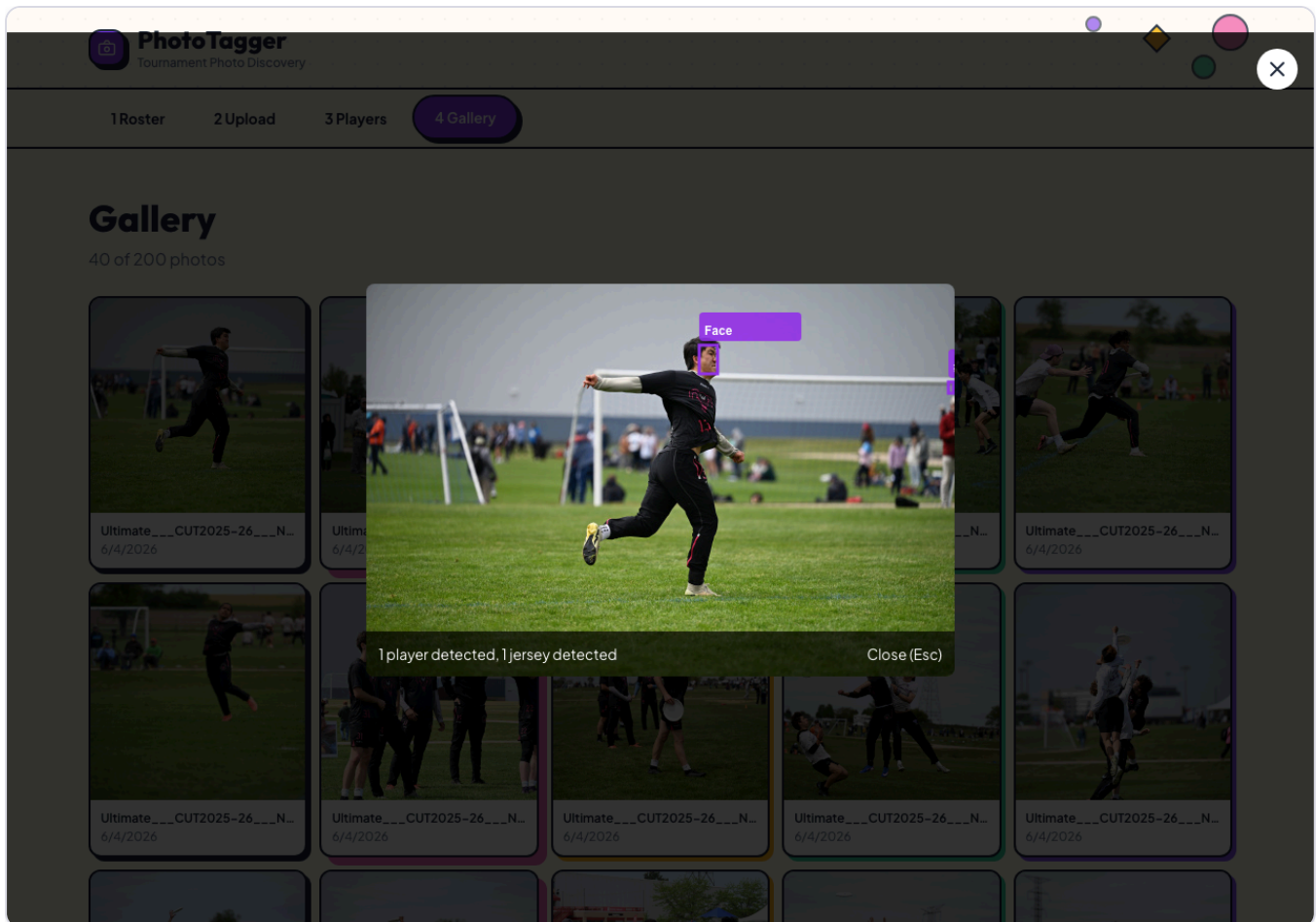
The **Gallery** tab is the final, searchable view of every photo with its tags applied.



- Each thumbnail shows the photo and its filename.
- The colored border indicates tagging status.
- Click any photo to open the **lightbox** for a full-size view with detection overlays.

Photo lightbox

The lightbox overlays what PhotoTagger detected directly on the image:



- **Face boxes** mark each detected player.
- **Jersey boxes** mark each read number.
- A caption summarizes the detections (e.g. "*1 player detected, 1 jersey detected*").
- Identified players are labeled by name.

This is the view you'll share with players: "here's every photo of you from the tournament."

Putting it together — a typical session

1. **Roster** → import both teams' rosters (drag a CSV or paste a URL).
2. **Upload** → select the game's photo folder, pick Team A/Team B, set their jersey colors, and save.
3. Wait for detection + OCR to finish.
4. **Players** → click **Re-detect & Cluster**, then tag the largest unnamed clusters.
5. **Gallery** → search and share. Done.

Troubleshooting

Symptom	Likely cause	Fix
No jersey numbers detected	Photos don't show clear numbers, or jersey colors weren't set	Set Team A/B jersey colors in Upload → Game Details , then re-upload
Players not matched to names	Jersey color mismatch	Verify Team A/B colors in Upload → Game Details match the photos
A face is in the wrong cluster	Clustering grouped two people	Open the player detail page and deselect the wrong photo
Same player appears as two cards	Faces clustered separately	Tag both with the same roster player to consolidate them
New photos not showing tags	Detection hasn't re-run	Click Re-detect & Cluster on the Players tab
Page won't load	Connectivity or the site is restarting	Refresh the page; check your internet connection and try again shortly

Reference

- **App URL:** <https://phototagger-production.up.railway.app/upload>
- **Supported photo formats:** JPG, PNG, TIFF, HEIC, WebP
- **Supported roster formats:** CSV, TXT, MD, XLSX, PDF, or a roster URL
- Project setup and architecture: see [README.md](#) and [CLAUDE.md](#)